THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 04

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Plastic: Convenient but Costly

Plastic is one of the most useful materials ever invented. It is light, cheap, strong and waterproof, and it can be moulded into anything from a toothbrush to a pipe. It is hardly surprising that, in less than a hundred years, it has found its way into almost every house on the planet. But the very qualities that make plastic so useful also make it a problem. It does not rot, and so a bag thrown away today may remain on the ground for hundreds of years.

A large part of the plastic we use is meant to be used once and thrown away: carry bags, straws, cups and wrappers. These items are often dropped carelessly on streets and in parks, from where they are carried by rain into drains and rivers and finally into the sea. Fish and turtles mistake pieces of plastic for food, and many have been found dead with their stomachs full of it. Cows that wander through our cities swallow plastic bags along with vegetable waste and fall seriously ill.

Burning plastic is not a solution either. It sends poisonous fumes into the air, which cause breathing problems and harm the environment. Recycling is better, but only a small proportion of plastic is sorted and recycled; the rest ends up in landfills.

The answer lies in the old rule of the three Rs: reduce, reuse and recycle. We can reduce by refusing a bag when we do not need one. We can reuse containers and bottles, and carry a cloth bag when we go shopping. Where plastic must be thrown away, we should put it in a separate bin so that it can be recycled. Several Indian states have banned single-use plastic, but laws alone cannot work unless every citizen cooperates.

(i) Plastic is a problem mainly because it: 1

(a) is expensive **(b)** breaks easily

(c) does not rot **(d)** is heavy

(ii) Animals are harmed when they: 1

(a) mistake plastic for food **(b)** see bright colours

(c) eat grass **(d)** drink clean water

(iii) Burning plastic is not a solution because it: 1

(a) makes noise **(b)** gives out poisonous fumes

(c) is costly **(d)** takes too long

(iv) 'Single-use' items are those that are: 1

(a) used once and thrown away **(b)** very strong

(c) used for years **(d)** made of cloth

(v) The three Rs are: 1

(a) reduce, reuse, recycle **(b)** rest, relax, repair
(c) read, write, run **(d)** recall, remove, repeat

(vi) State whether True or False: Most plastic is recycled in our country. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Why does a plastic bag remain on the ground for hundreds of years? 1

(viii) Name two single-use plastic items mentioned. 1

(ix) What does 'they' refer to in 'from where they are carried by rain' (paragraph 2)? 1

(x) What can individuals do to reduce plastic waste? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Gift of the Old Clock

The clock in the Sharma household stood in the corner of the drawing room and had not worked for years. Its brass pendulum hung still and its face was dull with dust. Everyone agreed that it was an eyesore, and Meera's mother often said that it should be sold to the scrap dealer.

Meera, however, loved it. It had belonged to her great-grandfather, who had carried it all the way from Lahore when the family moved to Jaipur. One Sunday, while her parents were out, she decided to find out why it had stopped. She unscrewed the back panel with a kitchen knife and found that a small cogwheel had slipped from its place. Nothing was broken. It had simply been waiting for somebody to notice.

It took her two hours, a pair of tweezers and a good deal of patience. When she finally pushed the wheel into position and swung the pendulum, the clock gave a hesitant tick, then another, and then settled into a steady rhythm. Meera sat on the floor and listened to it as if it were the heartbeat of the house.

When her parents returned, her mother stopped at the door. "What is that sound?" she asked. Then she saw the clock and her eyes filled with tears. "My grandmother used to wind it every morning," she said softly. "I had forgotten how it sounded."

That evening, nobody spoke of selling the clock. Meera's father polished the brass, her mother set the right time, and the little girl, who had been scolded for using a knife, received a hug instead.

(i) The clock had been useless because: 1
(a) it had no face **(b)** its glass was broken
(c) it had no pendulum **(d)** a cogwheel had slipped

(ii) The clock came to Jaipur from: 1
(a) Mumbai **(b)** Lahore **(c)** Delhi **(d)** Agra

(iii) Meera's mother cried because: 1
(a) the clock was broken **(b)** Meera had hurt herself
(c) she was angry **(d)** the sound reminded her of her grandmother

(iv) The phrase 'a hesitant tick' suggests that the clock: 1
(a) ticked loudly **(b)** was very fast
(c) ticked slowly and uncertainly at first **(d)** refused to tick

(v) Which quality of Meera is shown in the story? 1
(a) laziness **(b)** pride **(c)** patience **(d)** greed

(vi) State whether True or False: Meera's mother always liked the old clock. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Whose clock was it originally? 1

(viii) What tools did Meera use to repair the clock? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'ugly thing to look at'. 1

(x) How did the family treat the clock at the end of the story? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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